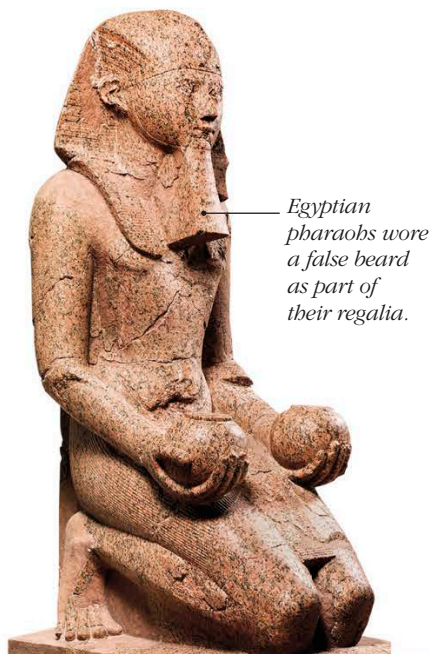




Egyptian pharaohs wore a false beard as part of their regalia.

Egyptian pharaoh

Hatshepsut

Where Egyptian Empire, North Africa

When c. 1507–1458 BCE

One of the few female rulers of Egypt to rule in her own right, Hatshepsut acted as regent to her stepson Thutmose III before becoming pharaoh herself. She reigned for about 20 years. Many statues of the time portrayed her in the traditional clothes worn by male pharaohs, complete with false beard.

Leaders of the ancient world

Across the ancient world, many extraordinary kings and queens left their mark on history. Some were remarkable military strategists who outwitted their enemies, while others ruled by brute force. Still others were great administrators, and successfully governed large and complex empires.

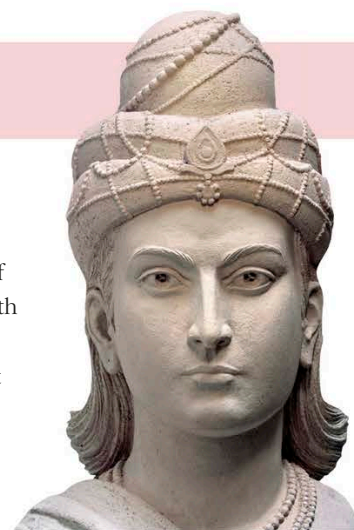
Mauryan emperor

Ashoka

Where Indian subcontinent, South Asia

When c. 304–c. 232 BCE

Ashoka the Great, ruler of the Mauryan Empire of South Asia, fought many violent battles on his path to power before embracing Buddhism, a religion that teaches nonviolence. Following the conquest of Kalinga, in modern-day India, he gave up war to spread the message of Buddhism throughout his empire and beyond.



Qin emperor

Qin Shi Huangdi

Where China, Asia

When 259–210 BCE

Zheng, king of Qin, took the name Qin Shi Huangdi (meaning “First Qin Emperor”) after conquering six other Chinese states and uniting them under the same laws, written language, and currency. After his death, Zheng was buried with the Terra-Cotta Army—a magnificent collection of sculpted clay warriors meant to protect him in the afterlife (see pp.34–35).

Roman ruler

Caesar Augustus

Where Roman Empire, Europe

When 63 BCE–14 CE

After decades of civil war, Caesar Augustus restored peace to the Roman world, and was proclaimed the first Roman emperor in 27 BCE. During his 40-year reign, he reformed the army and government, laying the foundations for a stable empire.

